



Russian Transformer car

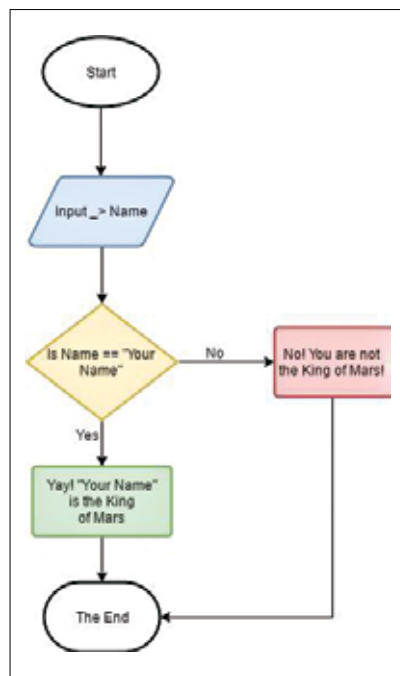
Called 'Optimus Gennadiyevich Praimov', a Russian father-son's VAZ-2110 Lada car can transform into a giant robot. <http://dgit.in/Russauto>



Drone journalist imprisoned

Aaron Turgeon, a citizen journalist from North Dakota is facing 7 years in prison for filming a protest with his drone. <http://dgit.in/DronePrison>

cine and even black-magic! However, Euclid's algorithm to find the Greatest Common Divisor or Highest Common Factor is widely accepted as one of the earlier forefathers of algorithms.



Flowchart Ascertaining you as the king of Mars!

Another area which has been vastly affected, or rather has existed due to algorithms is cryptography and cryptanalysis. And these algorithms have made nations and kings rise and fall. They have been able to start wars and stop them as well. The Caesar's cipher that was supposedly designed and used by Julius Caesar to send messages to his generals, Al-Kindi's manuscript on deciphering cryptographic messages, Alan Turing's machine to decrypt German secret

messages during the Second World War, modern day Hashing Algorithms like MD5 and SHA, and public-key cryptosystems like RSA are just a few of the vast number of cryptography related algorithms. These algorithms created the basis of modern day computers and computations and also go a long way back in establishing the roots of data security and integrity as well as the internet and network communications in general.

WRITE YOUR OWN

Enough of words! Now let's write some real ones! There are different ways to approach algorithms and write them down. There are many ways to express them as well, for e.g. you could write an algorithm in plain language or write it as pseudo code (i.e. logical representation in code like blocks) or even as a specific piece of code in some programming language. Another popular way of expressing algorithms is via a set of simple shapes and diagrams known as flow charts.

The first step of writing algorithms is understanding your problem statement and jotting down the approach to solve it. Once you have the solution try to prove that all negative cases and positive cases are sufficed. So, if you want to write an algorithm that proves that you are the King of Mars, then your algorithm must always prove that you are the king of Mars and for any other person it must say that he/she is not the King of Mars. In fact, let's try and draw a flow chart for the same, as shown in the image above.

Now, here is an algorithm showing how to approach writing

*CODING MATTERS

>>Interesting developer videos



*MIT Algorithms Course

This course offers an introduction to the world of algorithmic thinking. Instructor Srinivas Devadas goes onto various popular sorting algorithms before explaining data structures. <http://dgit.in/MITAlgo>



*How algorithms shape our world

Kevin Slavin argues that we're living in a world designed for -- and increasingly controlled by -- algorithms. In this riveting talk from TEDGlobal, he shows how these complex computer programs determine espionage tactics, stock prices, movie scripts, etc. Slavin also warns that we are writing code we can't understand uncontrolled implications. <http://dgit.in/AlgoWorld>

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